

OFFICIAL CEO GUIDEBOOK

NANO GAMES

Prepared for CEO Cyrus



This book explains your arcade — what it is, how it works, what your job is as the boss, and how you could turn it into a real business one day. Read it, keep it, and come back to it anytime you have a new idea.

Written for Cyrus, Founder & CEO of Nano Games

1 What Has Been Built

You now own a real website called **Nano Games** — think of it like your very own game store on the internet, except every game in it can be one YOU made up.

Right now your store has **2 games** in it, and **2 empty shelves** ("Coming Soon" cards) waiting for whatever you dream up next.

Game 1 — Aquatic Survival

You play as Aqua, a tough little turtle, fighting off wave after wave of enemies and giant animal bosses underwater and on land. The goal: survive as long as you can.

Game 2 — Elemental Trials

You battle 7 elemental guardians (Water, Fire, Earth, Lightning, Ice, Poison, Wind), and there's even a secret hidden world with 5 MORE bosses if you find the secret portal. You collect weapons, merge them together to make them stronger, and can even loop the whole game again on higher difficulty for better rewards.

The Trophy Case (Leaderboard)

Both games have a "Top Scores" button. When someone finishes a run, they can type their name in and their score gets saved forever — so you (and everyone who plays) can see who's the best in the world at your games.

Fun fact: every game has its OWN trophy case. Aquatic Survival scores don't mix with Elemental Trials scores — each game gets to crown its own champion.

2 How It All Works

You don't need to know how to code to be the CEO — but every good boss understands roughly how their company runs. Here's the simple version:

Part	What it really is	What it does
The Website	The front door	The page people see first — your logo, your 3 game shelves, your stats.
Each Game	Its own little room	One single file holds the ENTIRE game — art, sounds, controls, everything.
The Trophy Case	A magic notebook in the cloud	A database (a super-organized digital notebook) that remembers every score, forever, even if the computer turns off.
The Host (Vercel)	The power company	Keeps your website turned ON and available to anyone, anywhere, 24 hours a day — even while you're asleep.

Think of it like a real arcade building: the **website** is the storefront, each **game** is an arcade cabinet, the **trophy case** is the high-score board bolted to the wall, and **Vercel** is the electric company making sure the lights never go out.

3 Your Job: Game Designer & CEO

As the CEO, YOU decide what games go into your arcade. Here's how a new game gets from "idea in your head" to "playable on the website":

1. **Dream it up.** What's the game about? Who's the hero? What are the bad guys? How do you win?
2. **Build or describe it.** You can build the whole game yourself, or describe it in detail and work with a grown-up (and Claude) to build it.
3. **Hand off the finished file.** One game = one file. When it's ready to play, it gets handed over to be added to the arcade.
4. **It gets wired in.** The trophy case gets connected, a card gets made for the home page, and it goes live for the whole world to play.

You are the Game Designer. That means the ideas, the characters, the difficulty, the art style, the vibe — all of that is 100% your call. Nobody can tell you your game idea is wrong.

Things a good Game Designer does

- Plays their OWN games a lot, to find what's fun and what's boring.
- Writes down ideas the second they think of them (keep a notebook!).
- Isn't afraid to change something that isn't fun yet.
- Decides which "Coming Soon" shelf gets filled next.

4 Telling Friends & Family

A store with no customers isn't much of a business. Here's how to get people to visit (with a grown-up's help sending links):

Your elevator pitch

"I built a video game website called **Nano Games**. It's got a turtle survival game and a boss-battle game with 12 bosses. You can play for free right in your browser — no downloading anything. Try to beat my high score!"

Easy ways to spread the word

- **Send the link** in a family group chat: "Check out the arcade I made!"
- **Challenge them** — "Bet you can't beat my score of ____." A challenge always gets people to click.
- **Show, don't just tell** — play it in front of them for 30 seconds so they see how fun it is.
- **Ask them to share it** with 2 more people. That's how something small grows big.
- **Update people** when a new game goes live — "New game just dropped!" is exciting news.

TRY IT: Write your own 1-sentence pitch

5 Your Domain Name

You did it — your arcade has its own real address. Not a free one that ends in someone else's name. Your own:

nanogames . app

This is what a grown-up calls a **domain**. It's the shop sign out front. When you tell a friend where to play your games, this is the whole thing you say — two words and a dot. That's it.

Why this one works: it's short, you can say it out loud without spelling it, and it doesn't have anything in it a friend could get wrong. Those are the three tests a good name has to pass. Say a name out loud before you fall in love with it.

TRY IT: you have one week to tell 5 people the new name. Write down who you told, and what they said

1st choice: _____ 2nd choice:

3rd choice: _____

6 💰 Money Quest — Level Up Your Arcade

Here's a secret: almost every big video game company started exactly like yours — one person with one game and an idea. Below are **5 real ways** arcades like yours make money. Read each "Quest Card," then fill out the worksheet with what YOU think. There are no wrong answers — this is just you thinking like a real CEO.

Quest 1: The Supporter Club ❤️

DIFFICULTY: EASY · NEEDS A GROWN-UP TEAMMATE

What it is: A button on your site that says "Support Nano Games." People who love your games (family, friends) can send a small amount of money — like \$1, \$5, or \$10 — just to say "keep making cool stuff!"

👍 Good things

Easiest one to set up. People WANT to support kids who make things.

😬 Tricky things

A grown-up has to run the actual payment account — you can't do it alone yet.

WORKSHEET

Who do I think would support me? _____

What would I say to ask them? _____

My excitement level: ★★★★★ (circle your rating)

Quest 2: The Merch Corner

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM · NEEDS A GROWN-UP TEAMMATE

What it is: Put your game characters (Aqua the turtle! The elemental guardians!) on real t-shirts, hoodies, or stickers that people can actually buy and wear.

Good things

People love wearing stuff from games they enjoy. Feels very "real company."

Tricky things

Takes longer to set up, and someone has to design the shirt art.

WORKSHEET

Which character would I put on a shirt first? _____

What would I call the design? _____

My excitement level: ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ (circle your rating)

Quest 3: Sponsor-a-Boss 🐉

DIFFICULTY: EASY · MOST PERSONAL ONE

What it is: Someone who loves you (grandma, an uncle, a best friend) pays a small amount to get a **brand-new boss or character named after them** (or their pet!) built into your NEXT game. Very special, very one-of-a-kind.

👍 Good things

Super fun and personal — people love seeing themselves in a game.

😬 Tricky things

You have to actually build the new boss, which takes creative work.

WORKSHEET

Who's the first person I'd offer this to? _____

What kind of boss would I design for them? _____

My excitement level: ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ (circle your rating)

Quest 4: The CEO Paycheck

DIFFICULTY: EASY · STARTS TODAY

What it is: Treat game-making like a real job. You and your family agree on a set amount you get paid every time you finish and ship a new game or a big new feature — like a commission for real work delivered.

Good things

You don't need any customers — you get paid for the WORK, right away.

Tricky things

Only works as long as your family agrees to be the "customer."

WORKSHEET

What would be a fair paycheck per finished game? \$ _____

What counts as "finished"? _____

My excitement level: ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ (circle your rating)

Bonus Quest: Arcade Ads 🎮 (SOMEDAY)

DIFFICULTY: HARD · NEEDS AN ADULT ACCOUNT / AGE RULES

What it is: Big websites often show small ads and earn a tiny bit of money every time someone sees one. It's how a LOT of free games make money.

👍 Good things

Doesn't cost players anything — the game stays free.

😬 Tricky things

Ad companies require the account holder to be an adult, so this one waits until a grown-up sets it up on your behalf, or you're older.

WORKSHEET

Would ads make the games feel less fun? _____

My excitement level: ★★ ★★ ★★ ★★ (circle your rating)

🎯 Final Boss: Pick Your First Quest

Quest	My rating (1–5 stars)	Would I try this first?
1. Supporter Club		
2. Merch Corner		
3. Sponsor-a-Boss		
4. CEO Paycheck		
5. Arcade Ads (someday)		

The quest I'm picking first is:



Certificate of CEO-ship

This certifies that

CYRUS

is the Founder, CEO, and Head Game Designer of
Nano Games, and has full authority over which games get built next.

Cyrus, CEO

Date